

Word family: **engineer / engineers / engineered / engineering**

Base word: engineer

Plural noun: engineers

Verb forms: engineer / engineers / engineered / engineering

Related noun: engineering

Related forms / extensions:

engineer (n.) — 工程師

engineer (v.) — 設計並建造；策劃；操控促成

engineering (n.) — 工程學；工程技術；工程工作

civil engineer — 土木工程師

mechanical engineer — 機械工程師

electrical engineer — 電機 / 電氣工程師

software engineer — 軟件工程師

structural engineer — 結構工程師

chemical engineer — 化學工程師

engineered product/material — 經工程設計製成的產品 / 材料

reverse engineering — 逆向工程

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Meaning in this passage

> Looking ahead, I honestly think he will grow into a very creative person, whether he becomes a designer, an **engineer**, or something completely different.

Here, **engineer** means:

a person professionally trained to design, build, develop, or improve machines, structures, systems, or technology — 工程師

中文翻譯：

展望未來，我真的覺得他會成為一個很有創意的人，不論他將來成為設計師、**工程師**，還是從事完全不同的工作。

The word fits Leo because the passage repeatedly shows his interest in:

- * building things,
- * how things work,
- * structures,
- * models,

* problem-solving.

So here:

engineer = 運用科學、數學和技術知識去設計、建造或改善系統、機器、結構等的專業人士

1. **engineer (工程師) — 工程師**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> He may become a designer, an **engineer**, or something completely different.

他將來可能成為設計師、**工程師**，或者從事完全不同的工作。

Practice 2

> She works as an **engineer** for a technology company.

她在一家科技公司擔任**工程師**。

Practice 3

> A good **engineer** needs both technical knowledge and problem-solving skills.

優秀的**工程師**既需要技術知識，也需要解難能力。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****engineer = 運用科學、數學及技術知識來設計、建造、測試或改善實際系統與產品的專業人士****

2. **civil engineer — 土木工程師**

Practice 1

> The bridge was designed by a team of **civil engineers**.

這座橋由一隊**土木工程師**設計。

Practice 2

> She wants to become a **civil engineer**.

她想成為一名**土木工程師**。

MCQ-ready definition:

civil engineer = 專門處理道路、橋樑、建築基礎、水利等公共基建工程的工程師

3. **structural engineer — 結構工程師**

Practice 1

> A **structural engineer** checked whether the building was safe.

一名**結構工程師**檢查了建築物是否安全。

Practice 2

> The **structural engineer** calculated how much weight the bridge could support.

結構工程師計算了橋樑可以承受多少重量。

MCQ-ready definition:

structural engineer = 專門分析和設計建築物、橋樑等承重結構的工程師

4. **mechanical engineer — 機械工程師**

Practice 1

> He works as a **mechanical engineer**.

他是一名**機械工程師**。

Practice 2

> The **mechanical engineer** redesigned the cooling system.

那名**機械工程師**重新設計了冷卻系統。

MCQ-ready definition:

mechanical engineer = 專門設計、分析和改良機械及機械系統的工程師

5. **electrical engineer** — 電機 / 電氣工程師

Practice 1

> She is an **electrical engineer**.

她是一名**電機工程師**。

Practice 2

> The **electrical engineers** worked on the power system.

電氣工程師負責處理供電系統。

MCQ-ready definition:

electrical engineer = 專門研究、設計和維護電力、電路或電子系統的工程師

6. **software engineer** — 軟件工程師

Practice 1

> He works as a **software engineer**.

他是一名**軟件工程師**。

Practice 2

> The company hired several **software engineers** to build the new platform.

公司聘請了幾名**軟件工程師**來開發新平台。

MCQ-ready definition:

software engineer = 使用工程化方法設計、開發、測試和維護軟件系統的人

7. **chemical engineer** — 化學工程師

Practice 1

> She studied to become a **chemical engineer**.

她修讀相關課程，希望成為一名**化學工程師**。

Practice 2

> **Chemical engineers** often work on large-scale industrial processes.

化學工程師經常參與大型工業生產流程的設計與改善。

MCQ-ready definition:

chemical engineer = 運用化學、物理及工程原理來設計和改善工業生產過程的工程師

8. **engineering (工程學 ; 工程技術) — 工程學 ; 工程技術**

Practice 1

> She studies **engineering** at university.

她在大學修讀**工程學**。

Practice 2

> Modern **engineering** has transformed transport and communication.

現代**工程技術**改變了交通和通訊。

MCQ-ready definition:

engineering = 運用科學、數學和技術原理來設計、建造和改善實用系統的學科與實踐

9. **engineering project — 工程項目**

Practice 1

> The bridge is a major **engineering project**.

這座橋是一項大型**工程項目**。

Practice 2

> Students worked together on a small **engineering project**.

學生一起完成了一個小型**工程項目**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****engineering project = 涉及技術設計、建造、測試或改良的工程工作****

10. ****engineer something (設計 / 建造) — 設計並建造；精密構造****

As a verb, ****engineer**** can mean to deliberately design or construct something using technical knowledge.

Practice 1

> The system was carefully ****engineered**** for safety.

這個系統經過精心****工程設計****，以確保安全。

Practice 2

> The structure was ****engineered to withstand strong winds****.

這個結構被****設計成可以抵受強風****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****engineer something = 運用工程或技術方法精心設計、建造或安排某物****

11. ****be engineered to do something — 被設計成能夠……****

Practice 1

> The material is ****engineered to resist heat****.

這種材料被****設計成能抵受高溫****。

Practice 2

> The device was ****engineered to use less energy****.

這部裝置被****設計成使用較少能源****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be engineered to do something = 經過技術設計，使某物具有特定功能或效果****

12. ****engineered material / product — 工程設計材料 / 產品****

Practice 1

> The floor is made from **engineered wood**.

地板由**工程木材 / 人造複合木材**製成。

Practice 2

> The company develops specially **engineered materials**.

公司開發特別**工程設計的材料**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****engineered + noun = 經過技術設計、加工或改良，以達到特定性能的****

13. ****engineer an outcome / situation (figurative) — 策劃；安排促成****

This is a major figurative verb sense.

Practice 1

> He ****engineered a deal**** between the two companies.

他****策劃促成了****兩家公司之間的交易。

Practice 2

> She carefully ****engineered the situation**** so that everyone would agree.

她精心****安排整個局面****，讓所有人都会同意。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****engineer an outcome/situation = 有計劃地安排多項因素，使某個結果出現****

14. ****engineer someone's success / defeat — 策劃促成成功 / 失敗****

Practice 1

> The coach ****engineered the team's victory**** with a clever tactical change.

教練透過巧妙的戰術改變****策劃促成了球隊勝利****。

Practice 2

> They were accused of **engineering his removal** from the position.

他們被指**策劃令他被撤職**。

MCQ-ready definition:

engineer + result = 有意策劃並操控事情，使某個結果發生

15. **reverse engineering — 逆向工程**

A common technical compound.

Practice 1

> The team used **reverse engineering** to understand how the device worked.

團隊利用**逆向工程**了解裝置如何運作。

Practice 2

> **Reverse engineering** can reveal the structure of a complex system.

逆向工程可以揭示複雜系統的結構。

MCQ-ready definition:

reverse engineering = 分析現有產品或系統，以推斷其設計、結構和運作方式的過程

Important distinction 1: **engineer vs designer**

This is especially important for your passage.

designer

focuses more on:

- * concept
- * form
- * appearance
- * user experience
- * function

engineer

focuses more on:

- * technical feasibility
- * structure
- * systems
- * scientific principles
- * how something actually works

But there is substantial overlap.

Leo fits both possibilities because he:

- * **imagines and designs** things
- * **asks how things work**

Important distinction 2: **engineer vs technician**

engineer

typically designs, analyzes, develops, or improves systems.

technician

more often installs, operates, tests, repairs, or maintains systems using technical skills.

For example:

- > an engineer may design the system
- > a technician may install or repair it

This distinction varies by industry and country, but it is useful for learners.

Important distinction 3: **engineer vs mechanic**

mechanic

usually repairs and maintains machines/vehicles.

engineer

more broadly designs or analyzes technical systems.

- > car mechanic

- > 汽車維修技師

- > mechanical engineer

- > 機械工程師

They are not interchangeable.

Important distinction 4: **engineer vs scientist**

scientist

primarily investigates and explains how the natural world works.

engineer

uses scientific knowledge to solve practical problems and create systems.

A simplified contrast:

- > scientist → understand

- > engineer → apply/design

Real work often overlaps, of course.

Important distinction 5: **engineering vs technology**

engineering

the disciplined design and development process.

technology

the tools, systems, techniques, and products resulting from or used in technical work.

- > engineering creates and improves technology

is a useful rough learner distinction.

Important distinction 6: **engineer (noun) vs engineer (verb)**

Noun

> She is an **engineer**.

她是工程師。

Verb

> They **engineered** the system.

他們設計並建造了這套系統。

This is a genuine POS shift.

Important distinction 7: **engineer technically vs engineer figuratively**

Technical

> They **engineered** a bridge.

他們以工程方法設計建造橋樑。

Figurative

> They **engineered** an agreement.

他們策劃促成協議。

The figurative sense extends the idea:

carefully design a technical system

→ **carefully arrange circumstances to produce a result**

Important distinction 8: **engineer a result vs cause a result**

cause

simply means make something happen.

engineer

strongly suggests:

- * deliberate planning
- * multiple steps
- * intentional arrangement

> The delay **caused** a problem.

延誤造成問題。

> They **engineered** the result.

他們有計劃地促成了這個結果。

Important distinction 9: **engineer vs build**

build

focuses on constructing something physically.

engineer

focuses on the technical design and problem-solving behind making it work.

> workers **built** the bridge

工人建造橋樑

> engineers **engineered** the bridge

工程師負責技術設計和工程安排

Important distinction 10: **engineering vs architecture**

architecture

often focuses on building design, spatial organization, aesthetic and functional planning.

engineering

focuses more on structural, mechanical, electrical, and technical performance.

For buildings, architects and engineers often collaborate.

Family-extension note

****Engineer**** is a strong learner family because it has two clearly established modern branches:

1. ****technical/professional****

- * engineer
- * engineering
- * engineered product
- * software/civil/mechanical engineer

2. ****figurative planning/manipulation****

- * engineer a deal
- * engineer an outcome
- * engineer someone's removal

The figurative branch preserves the same underlying concept:

****carefully design and arrange a complex system to produce a desired result****

So it is a genuine semantic extension rather than an unrelated homonym.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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engineer	工程師	technical professional	
civil engineer	土木工程師	infrastructure	
structural engineer	結構工程師	structural safety/design	
mechanical engineer	機械工程師	machines/systems	
electrical engineer	電機 / 電氣工程師	electricity/electronics	
software engineer	軟件工程師	software systems	
chemical engineer	化學工程師	industrial chemical processes	
engineering	工程學；工程技術	engineering discipline	
engineering project	工程項目	technical project	
engineer a system	工程設計系統	technically design	

engineered to do X 設計成能夠 X	designed for function
engineered material 工程設計材料	technically modified material
engineer a deal 策劃促成交易	deliberate arrangement
engineer an outcome 策劃促成結果	manipulate/plan result
reverse engineering 逆向工程	infer design from finished system

For your original sentence

> Looking ahead, I honestly think he will grow into a very creative person, whether he becomes a designer, an **engineer**, or something completely different.

Here:

engineer = 工程師

The word fits Leo particularly well because the passage has already shown two sides of him:

* **creative/imaginative** → possible **designer**

* **curious about how things work + enjoys building** → possible **engineer**

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 展望未來，我真的覺得他會成為一個很有創意的人，不論他將來成為設計師、**工程師**，還是從事完全不同的工作。

So the key sense is the straightforward **technical profession** meaning of **engineer**.